

GET A SEXY DESKTOP

Used to be a time we geeks would use classic mode to eke every last drop of performance out of our systems, but those days are long gone. With good configurations becoming very affordable, we think it's perfectly fine to waste a little CPU and memory on a sexy-looking desktop. Don't you?

RAINMETER

Rainmeter (<http://dgit.in/RMeterCustom>) is the king when it comes to adding widgets to your desktop, plus loads of functionality and monitoring tools as well. There are thousands of themes you can choose from (check Rainmeter forums and Deviantart), and you can just cherry pick the best elements to make your own masterpiece (the source code is incredibly easy to edit). You could also just blatantly copy someone else's sick setup (/r/Rainmeter anyone?) and call it day. One thing is for sure, your eye-candy needs will be sorted with this one.

FENCES

Many of us have desktops that look like our rooms – cluttered and untidy. Adn that can seriously get in the way of productivity or become a source of embarrassment when your desktop has to be seen by someone else. This is where Fences from Stardock comes in. Make 'fenced in' translucent or transparent areas for your folders to segregate and access them easily. These fences roll up to the title bar to make your screen look incredibly neat and organized. Fences does most of the grunt work automatically. It isn't free but you can try it out for 30 days to see if you like it. Get it from <http://dgit.in/FencesDck>.

GLASS2K

Although this has been abandoned and is no longer being developed, it still works. Download the 55 kB (yes, kilobyte!) installer from <http://dgit.in/Glass2k> and install it. Use [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [0] to [9] to change the transparency of any window. Simple, yet effective for those who like the sleek glass look.

START MENU TILES

If you are one of the 14 people on earth who actually like tiles in their start menu, you also know that some tiles end up looking really awful. TileCreator

allows you to create a tile that links to any application for much faster access. You need to download two things for this to work: The direct proxy file (<http://dgit.in/TilePrxy>) and the app from the Windows App Store (<http://dgit.in/TileCreator>). If you use Steam to play games, you can also install Steam Tile from (<http://dgit.in/SteamTile>) to get something better than a static and boring icon. And who really likes those anyway?

GO FULL MAC

If you yearn for more 'Mac' in your life and a Dock like RocketDock (<http://dgit.in/RcktDock>) is not enough, and installing Hackintosh seems like too much trouble, there are a couple of ways to make Windows to look like a Mac.

As always, there's an easy way and a hard way. The easy way is to just download Rainmeter and run a Mac theme like this one (<http://dgit.in/MacSierraDskpt>).

Now for the fun way (which non-geeks would call the hard way). This can end up better looking and more polished than the readymade themes, but only if you are ready to take some pain upon yourselves willingly.

1. First you need a high-res wallpaper, and the default MacOS Sierra one is ideal: <http://dgit.in/2pedpZt>
2. Download Rocket Dock if you haven't already and set it up. Next, download a MacOS themed skin and paste it into C:\Program Files (x86)\RocketDock\Skins and you can then select the skin from the Dock Settings. (See link below)
3. Download an icon pack for Rocket Dock that fits in with the style and

aesthetic you are going for. We've included an example. On any icon in the dock, Right click > Icon Settings > "+" and then pick individual icons for each shortcut on the dock. Download this: <http://dgit.in/2pX56iJ>

4. Download custom icon images from DeviantArt for the things you want, and change the icon in the file's properties. Move all non-essential things to a folder to make it look better. Delete all names of the items on the desktop by using the blank character ([Alt] + [255]) as the name.
5. Next, start Rainmeter and find a 'Mac Bar' / 'Rain Bar' skin that you like on Deviantart or the forums and set it up. Some icons won't give you functionality but here is one that is pretty good: <http://dgit.in/2ooEMB4>
And voila! that's it, you have your very own MacOS Sierra look!

RETRO LOOK

Want to go retro? Use Classic Shell (<http://dgit.in/2pYntXx>). You can make Windows 10 look like Windows 2000/XP/7 without all of the security holes. Download it, install it and choose the window and start menu feel that interests you. You can also choose to disable breadcrumbs to make pathfinding easier, and of course, our favourite, change the way the start button looks – including making your own button from scratch! You have got to try that feature, because it one of the few ways you can give your PC your own unique charm. By the time you're done with it, we're pretty sure that your PC wont look the same at all. 